



▲ MOSCOW STATE UNIVERSITY'S MAIN BUILDING DOMINATING THE CITY'S SKYLINE

Grundtvig's Church

Location Copenhagen, Denmark

Danish architect P. V. Jensen-Klint's Grundtvig's Church, built between 1921 and 1940, is an architectural oddity. More cathedral than church in its dimensions, it looms almost threateningly over the houses (also built by Jensen-Klint) that frame it. It is constructed entirely from brick, and its vast west front consists of three squat-arched entrances, over which a deeply striated triangle rises. Over this is an expanse of brick that climaxes in three giant, similarly striated triangular towers, their edges variations of the stepped gables of Danish medieval traditions. This brutal

monumentality is continued not just in the awkwardly angular flying buttresses at the east end, but also in the soaring and stark interior. The few windows the architect included are pencil thin.

Moscow State University

Location Moscow, Russia

The main building of Moscow State University was one of Josef Stalin's Seven Sisters, a series of skyscrapers through which the Communist leader sought to redefine the Moscow skyline. Designed by Lev Vladimirovich Rudnev, the building is a gargantuan propagandist symbol of Russia's postwar resurgence. On completion in 1953, it was the

tallest building in Europe. In style, it is a supremely over-the-top vision of totalitarian Baroque. The central tower, 787 ft (240 m) high, becomes more ornate as it climbs before culminating in a huge red star. On every side are similarly overblown, tower-studded wings. Much of the labor for its construction was provided by political prisoners. Its completion coincided almost exactly with Stalin's death.

Notre Dame du Haut

Location Ronchamp, France

After World War II, Le Corbusier was an architect reborn. His initial Modernist strictures gave way to an architecture more attuned to human needs. His attachment to concrete and steel never lessened. However, his new recognition—

that architecture should reflect rather than direct the vagaries of humanity—produced a series of remarkable buildings. His church of Notre Dame du Haut, completed in 1955, is a supreme example. Sinuous, organic, and innovative, it depicts Modernism transformed and recast. It has no obvious predecessors. Its curving walls and vast enveloping roof appear suddenly conjured, as if the result of a vivid imagination.

Jespersen Office Building

Location Copenhagen, Denmark

Completed in 1955, Danish architect Arne Jacobsen's Jespersen Office Building is cool, calm, restrained, and precisely detailed. If its regular pattern of green-gray panels does